

APP ECOSYSTEM



Whatsapp

Whatsapp allows you to stay in touch with your friends, relatives, acquaintances, etc. via whatever internet access you have on your phone or device. You can easily send group chats, share images and videos and so much more. Supporting push services and being platform independent, all that you would require is that your friends have the same app and your device is registered and you are set. The only drawback? Whatsapp is free only for a year and requires usage and activation fees after that.



Augmented reality

The future is augmented. The future is now. Augmented Reality is no more in the realms of science fiction. Apps are available right now that can turn your



device into a tricorder with a database backbone similar to that of the hitch-hiker's guide to the galaxy. All the information you would ever need can be at your fingertips at the click of a button. AR will soon be a way of life.



Bloom

Fancy yourself a modern Beethoven in the making but limited by your lack of musical knowledge or even the rudimentary knowledge regarding the use of musical instruments? Bloom is the app for you. Much like the theremin (<http://bit.ly/1icBj4>) of yore, this app allows you to create music by just tap-



ping anywhere on the screen, the position of the tap deciding the tone and pitch. You can quite literally tap like a maniac using the full power of multi-touch to create psychedelic masterpieces that are uniquely yours.



Evernote

You remember your old granny or teacher used to complain about you saying, "It's no use, this one's head is always in the clouds!" How right they were!



This app allows you to store all your flitting thoughts, memories, photos, etc. in the cloud and allows you to access them from anywhere. A virtual extension of your brain, it syncs to the cloud almost instantly. Beware the day the servers crash, your brain will be reduced to slush and you'll have not a thought in your head!



Handyscan

App developers have slowly started realising that your phone's camera can be so much more than just an image capture device. With the right processing software, such as Handyscan, you can convert any document, receipt, image, etc. into a very handy and portable pdf or jpg format.



If you're feeling lazy enough, you can even scan your signature and digitally sign your documents after that. The app even allows you to scan and fill up forms. The fabled paperless office can start right here.

\$1,000,000

is what Angry Birds makes from its ad-supported free versions alone. This mobile game has spread like wildfire and there is barely a platform that is unsupported and, with over five hundred million-downloads so far, Rovio is set to make billions from this game.



Yongzh

Yongzh, or Yong Zhang as he was originally named

is best known as the creator of the Nesoid, Snesoid, Genoid, N64oid, Ataroid, Gearoid and Gameboid series of emulators, with the pious purpose of bringing classic console gaming goodness to mobiles. Since it was illegal, his developer account was shutdown and he has now been kicked off the Android app marketplace. He still gives his apps away for free on SlideME.



QR codes

A QR code can contain quite a bit of data

for their size and you just need a phone with a camera and compatible software to read them. Everything is being converted to QR codes now, download links, advertisements, shopping tags, business cards, profile photos, etc. Next we'll be tagging our kids with QR codes and replace addresses, building names, number plates, etc. as well.



iTunes

When it comes to apps and app stores, it is the sheer numbers that boggle the mind. The store at the top of this "mind-boggling" list is iTunes. Starting off with about 200,000 apps in 2003, we are quite sure that apple was smugly confident that they had kick-started a revolution. We live in an age where the success or failure of a platform is defined by the number of apps available in the market, and the iTunes store is the yardstick by which other app stores are measured today.

